TIPZ

Private tips. Any asset. Zero trace.

Market Opportunity & Investment Thesis

January 2025 | Version 1.0

01. Executive Summary

The Problem

Creator platforms extract over $5 billion annually in fees from tips and donations. Meanwhile, every crypto transaction on public blockchains creates a permanent, traceable record—exposing both creators and supporters to financial surveillance.

The Solution

TIPZ is the first private, fee-free, crypto-native tipping infrastructure. Using Zcash shielded transactions, tips leave no trace. Creators keep 100% of support. Any token in, ZEC out—zero platform fees, zero surveillance.

The Opportunity

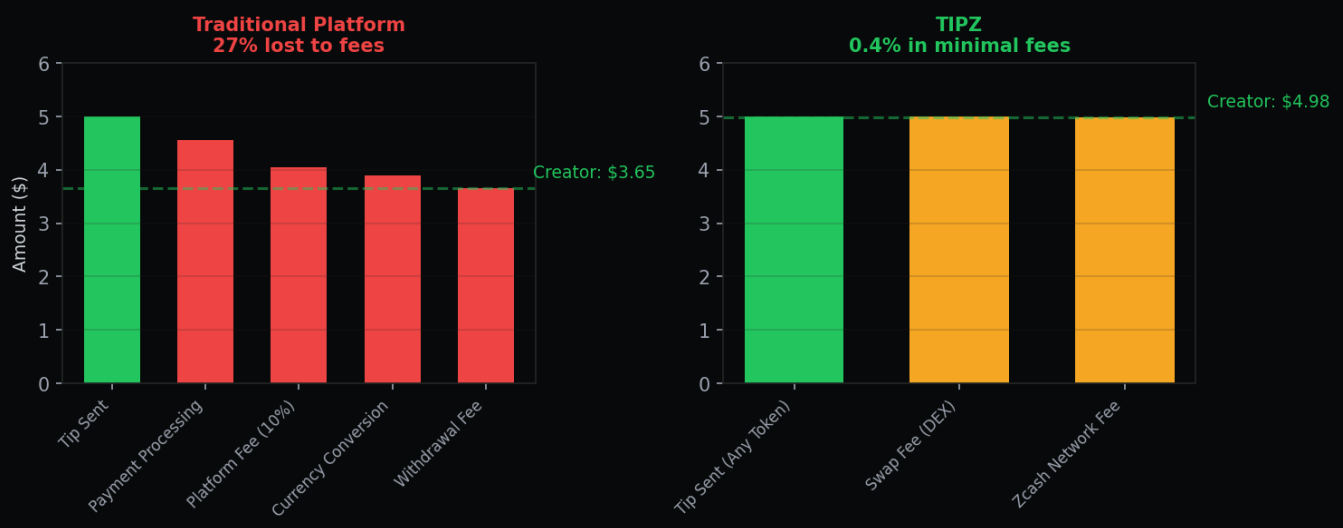
The creator tipping market is $2.9B with 350M+ annual transactions. 40% are micropayments under $10—exactly where current fee structures hurt most. Privacy-preserving crypto is surging: Zcash hit $5B market cap with 30% now shielded.

$2.9B	350M+	40%	$5B+
Creator Tipping Market	Annual Tips	Micropayments (<$10)	Extracted in Fees/Year

02. The Problem

The Fee Extraction Crisis

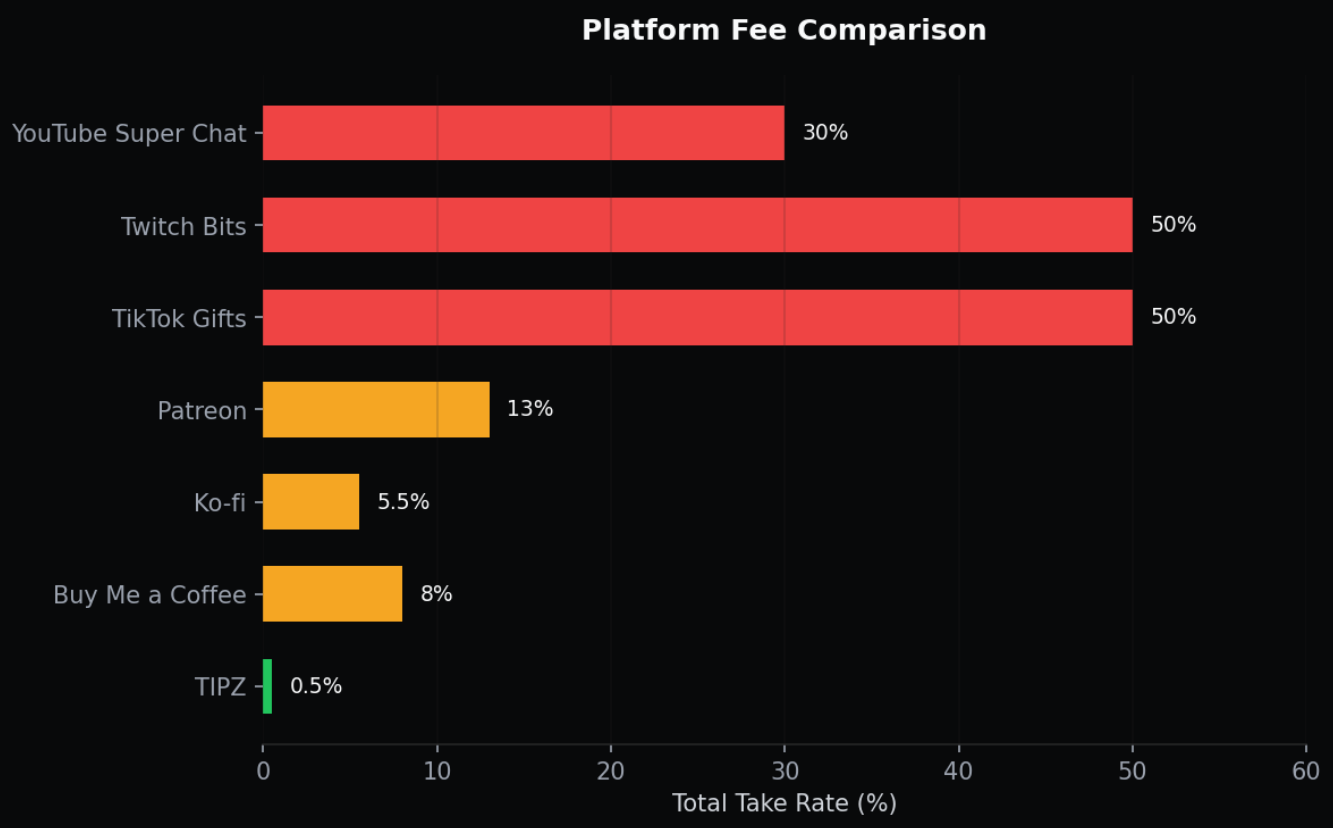
On a $5 tip through traditional platforms, creators lose up to 39% to fees. Payment processors take 2.9% + $0.30, platforms take 5-50%, and currency conversion adds more. Micropayments—the most common form of support—are hit hardest.



$5 Tip Breakdown: Traditional Platform vs TIPZ

Platform Concentration

A few platforms control creator monetization with extractive fee structures. Creators have no leverage. Supporters subsidize platform profits, not creators.



Platform Fee Comparison

Financial Surveillance

Every on-chain transaction is permanent and public. Wallet analytics companies sell creator financial data. Supporters can be deanonymized through chain analysis. 69% of consumers are worried about financial data misuse.

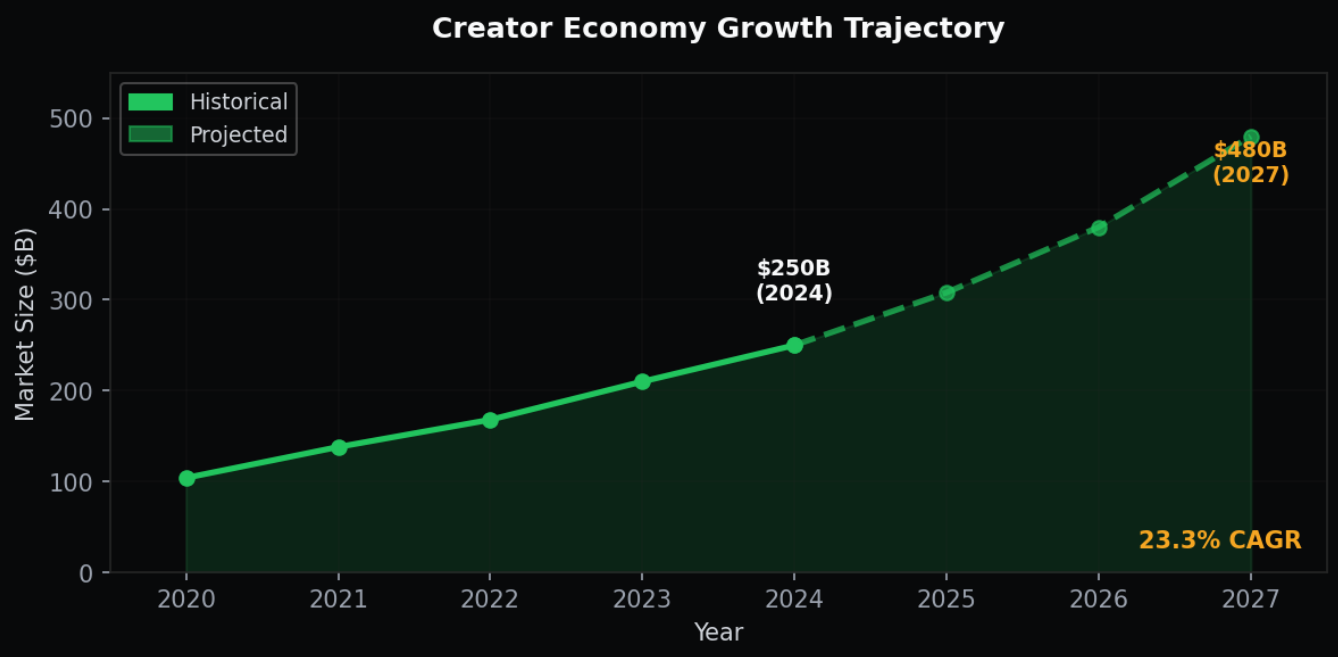
69%	72%	$50B
Worried about financial data misuse	Would switch for better data security	Digital payment fraud cost (2025)

"Every on-chain transaction is permanent.
Financial surveillance is the default."

03. Market Opportunity

Creator Economy

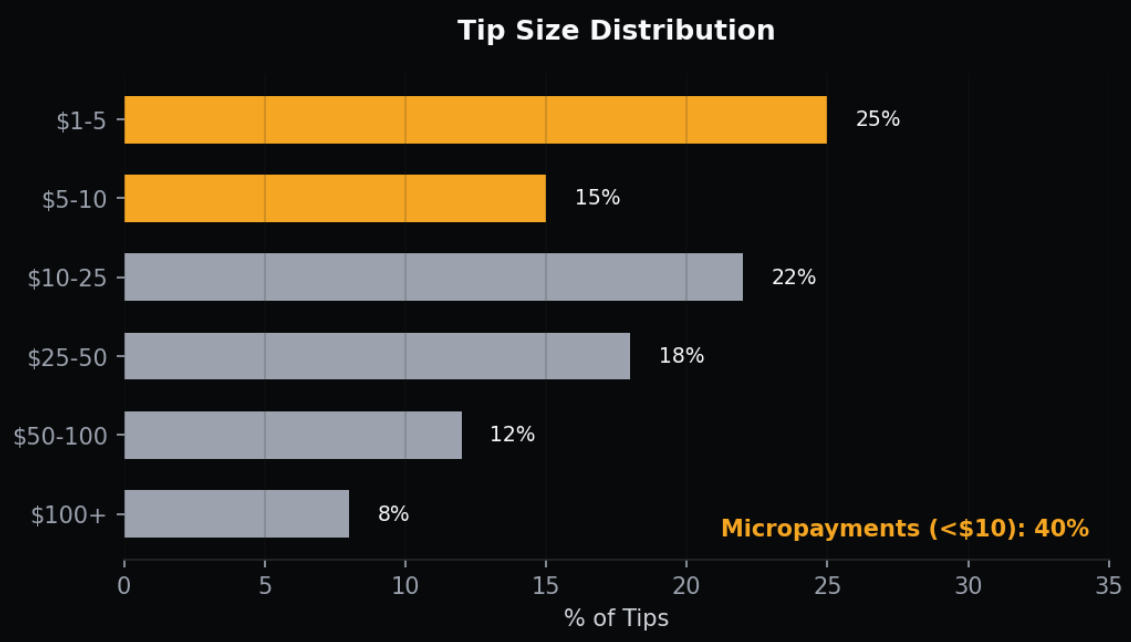
The creator economy has grown to **$250B** in 2024 and is projected to reach **$480B by 2027** at a **23.3% CAGR**. With 207M+ content creators worldwide and 54.9% now working full-time, the infrastructure for creator monetization is more critical than ever.



Source: Goldman Sachs, 2024

Tipping Market

The creator tipping market is valued at **$2.9B** with **350M+ tips annually**. Critically, **40% are micropayments under $10**—exactly where traditional fee structures cause the most damage. Over **$5B** is extracted from creators annually in platform and payment fees.

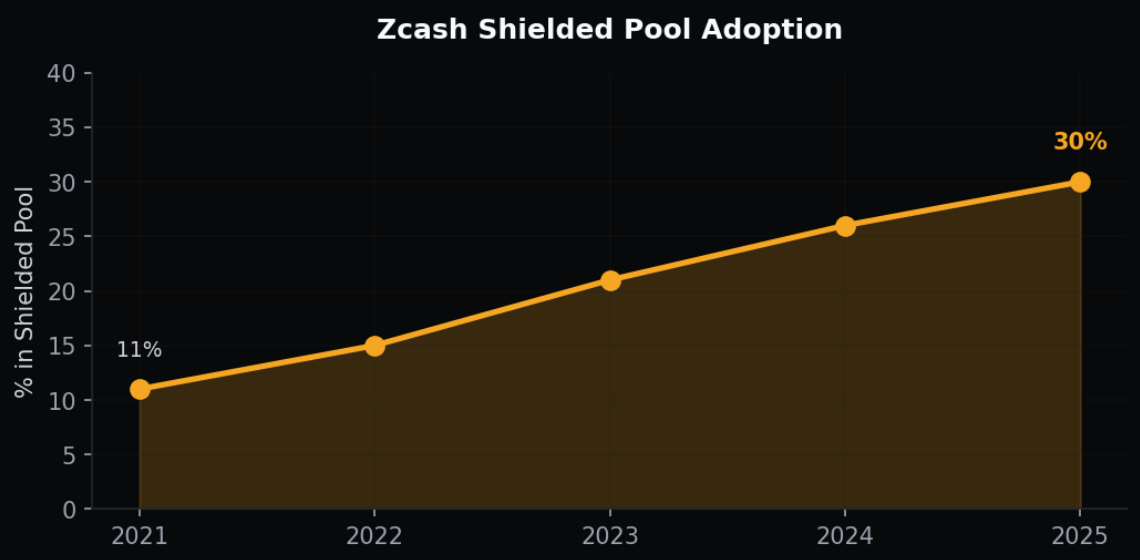


Tip Size Distribution (40% are micropayments)

Privacy Crypto Momentum

Privacy-preserving cryptocurrency is experiencing unprecedented growth. Zcash surged **700%** to a **$5B market cap**. The shielded pool now holds **30% of ZEC** (up from 11%), demonstrating strong demand for transaction privacy. **11.4%** of all crypto transactions now use privacy coins.

700%	$123M	886
ZEC Price Surge	Grayscale ZEC AUM	Merchants Accept ZEC



Source: Grayscale, Chainalysis, 2025

04. Competitive Landscape

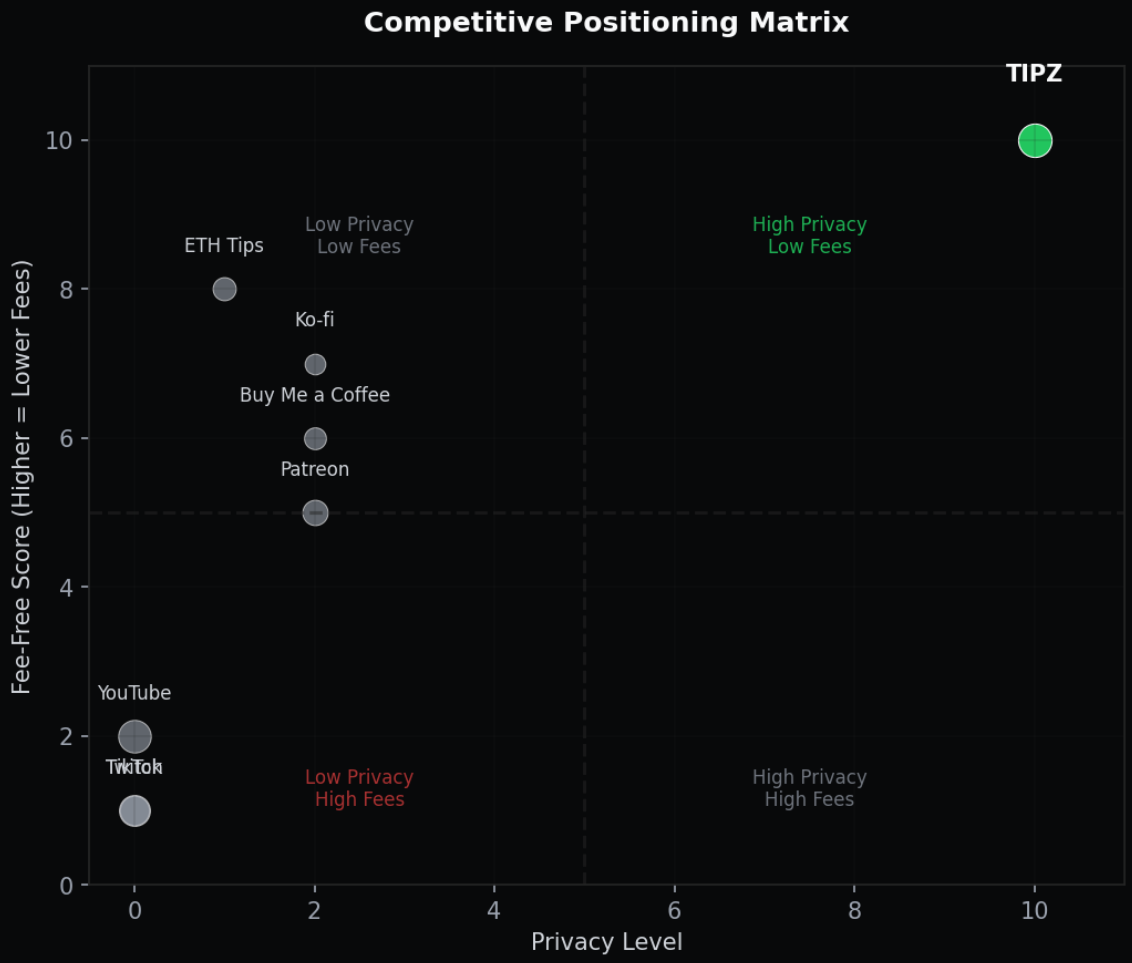
The creator tipping space is fragmented between traditional platforms with high fees and crypto solutions with no privacy. TIPZ occupies a unique position as the only solution that combines zero platform fees, full transaction privacy, self-custody, and any-token support.

Platform	Platform Fee	Payment Fee	Total Take	Privacy
YouTube Super Chat	30%	-	30%	None
Twitch Bits	50%	-	50%	None
TikTok Gifts	50%	-	50%	None
Patreon	8-12%	2.9% + $0.30	11-15%+	Low
Ko-fi	0-5%	2.9% + $0.30	3-8%+	Low
Buy Me a Coffee	5%	2.9% + $0.30	8%+	Low
Ethereum Tips	0%	Gas (~$2-20)	Variable	None
TIPZ	0%	~$0.02	~0.5%	Full

Feature Comparison

Feature	YouTube	Twitch	Patreon	Ko-fi	ETH Tips	TIPZ
Full Privacy	-	-	-	-	-	YES
Zero Platform Fee	-	-	-	YES	YES	YES
Self-Custody	-	-	-	-	YES	YES
Any Token Support	-	-	-	-	YES	YES
Micropayment Friendly	-	-	-	-	-	YES

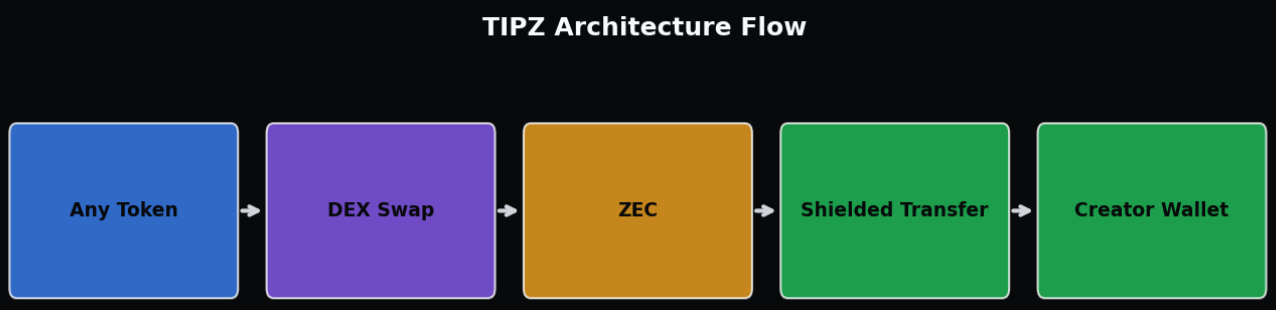
Competitive Positioning



TIPZ: The only high-privacy, fee-free solution

05. The TIPZ Solution

TIPZ is privacy-first tipping infrastructure for creators. Any token can be swapped to ZEC and delivered to a creator's shielded address. No trace. No fees. No platform capture.



TIPZ Transaction Flow

Product Components

Browser Extension [MVP Complete]

One-click tipping from X (Twitter). Detects creator profiles, shows tip button.

Creator Registration [MVP Complete]

Connect X handle to Zcash shielded address. Tweet-based verification.

Creator Directory [MVP Complete]

Discover registered creators. Search and browse tip-enabled profiles.

Token Swap Engine [In Development]

Automated any-token-to-ZEC swaps via DEX aggregation.

Value Proposition

For Creators:

> **Keep 100%**: Zero platform fees. Only minimal network costs.

> **Full Privacy**: Income invisible to chain analysis and surveillance.

> **Self-Custody**: Your keys, your crypto. No platform can freeze funds.

> **Any Asset**: Accept tips in any token, receive in ZEC.

For Tippers:

> **Anonymous Support**: No one knows you tipped. No traceable record.

> **Direct Impact**: Creators get the full amount. No middleman extraction.

> **Any Token**: Tip from any wallet, any chain, any token.

> **Low Fees**: Micropayments are finally viable. ~$0.02 per tip.

06. Business Model & Projections

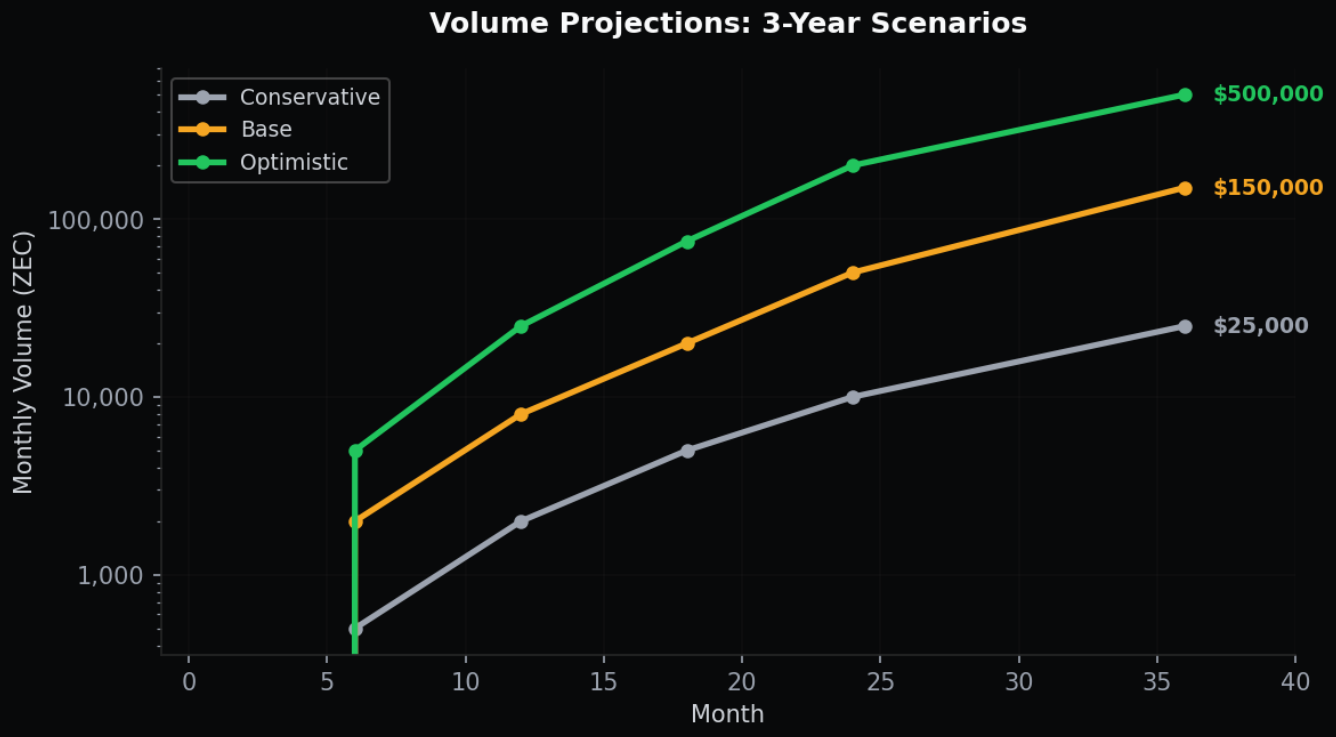
Revenue Model

Zero Platform Fees [Active]: TIPZ charges no platform fees. Growth driven by network effects and grants.

Future: Premium Features [Planned]: Optional analytics, custom profiles, API access for power creators.

Future: Enterprise Licensing [Exploratory]: White-label privacy tipping infrastructure for other platforms.

Volume Projections



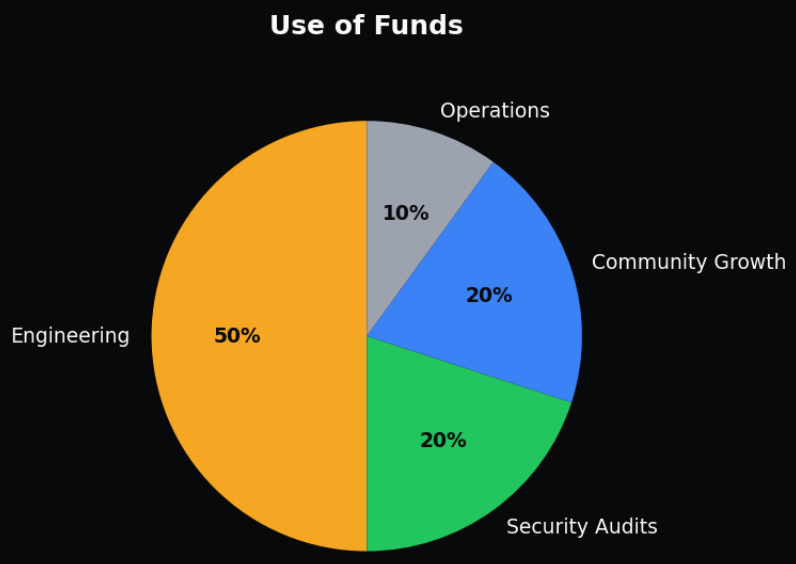
Monthly ZEC Volume: 3-Year Scenarios

Key Assumptions:

- Average tip: $15 equivalent in ZEC

- ZEC price: $50 (conservative baseline)
- Creator retention: 60% after 6 months
- Tipper conversion: 5% of creator followers

Use of Funds


Use of Funds
Operations
10%
Community Growth
20%
Engineering
50%
20%
Security Audits

07. Go-to-Market Strategy

Target Segments

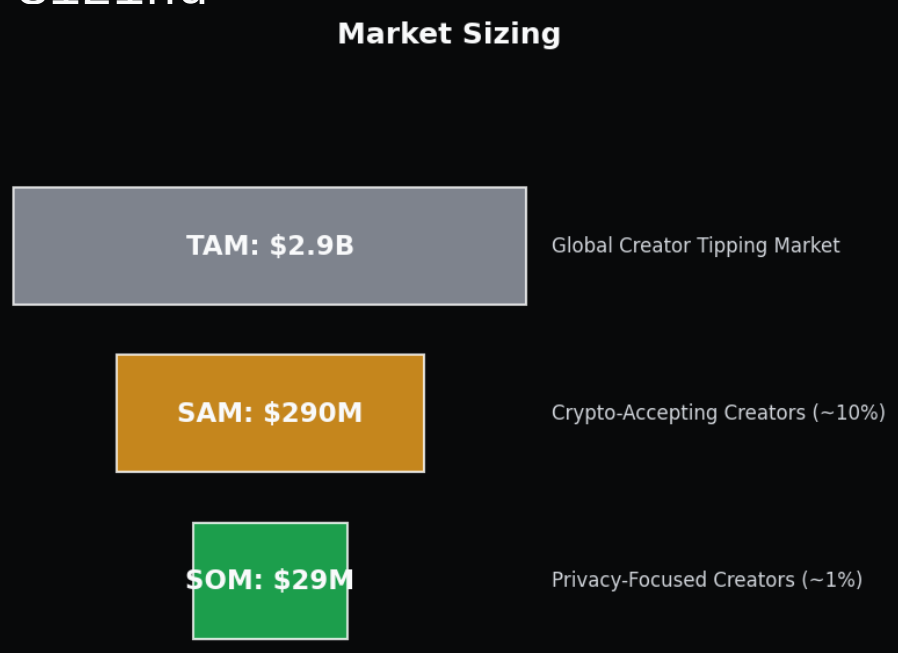
Crypto-Native Creators [Primary]
Already in crypto, need better tipping than ETH addresses (~500K creators)

Privacy Advocates [Primary]
Journalists, activists, content creators in sensitive spaces (~100K creators)

Zcash Community [Launch]
Existing ZEC holders, community members, advocates (~50K active users)

Mainstream Creators [Future]
Long-term: creators seeking fee-free alternatives (~10M+ creators)

Market Sizing



Launch Phases

Phase 1: Foundation (Q1-Q2 2025)

> Launch on X (Twitter) with browser extension

> 100 registered creators

> Zcash community adoption

Phase 2: Growth (Q3-Q4 2025)

> Multi-chain token support

> 1,000 registered creators

> Partnership with crypto media

Phase 3: Scale (2026)

> Platform API for integrations

> 10,000+ registered creators

> Additional social platform support

08. Team & Advisors

[PLACEHOLDER - TO BE FILLED]

Founding Team

[Founder Name]

Founder & CEO

[Brief bio highlighting relevant experience in crypto, privacy tech, or creator economy]

[Technical Lead]

CTO

[Brief bio highlighting relevant technical experience]

Advisors

[Advisor Name] | [Organization]
[Relevant expertise]

09. Traction & Metrics

[PLACEHOLDER - TO BE FILLED WITH CURRENT METRICS]

Key Metrics

[X] Registered Creators [+Y% MoM]	[X] Extension Installs [+Y% MoM]
[X ZEC] Total ZEC Tipped [+Y% MoM]	[X] Monthly Active Tippers [+Y% MoM]

Partnership Pipeline

[Partner 1] | In Discussion
[Brief description]

[Partner 2] | Letter of Intent
[Brief description]

Grant Applications

[Grant Name] | [Amount] | Applied/Awarded

10. Investment Opportunity

Building Privacy Infrastructure for the Creator Economy

Investment/Grant Ask: [Investment amount or grant request]

12-Month Milestones

- Launch multi-chain token swap support
- 1,000 registered creators
- Complete security audit
- $100K+ monthly tip volume
- Partnership with major crypto publication

18-Month Milestones

- Platform API public launch
- 5,000+ registered creators
- Second social platform integration
- $500K+ monthly tip volume

Website: https://tipz.app
Email: [contact@tipz.app]
Twitter: @tipzapp

11. Appendix: Sources

Creator Economy Market

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